

SHASHIDHARA NARAYANAPPA

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EDUCATION

M.S., Human Computer Interaction

May 2026

Indiana University | GPA : 3.8

Capstone: Autonomous Mobility as Social Service (Toyota Mobility Foundation)

EXPERIENCE

Lead Software Developer | Zero Distance Metaverse Pvt. Ltd., Bengaluru, India

Aug 2021 - Present

- Built reusable React component library with TypeScript for online events platform, creating modular UI system used across 25+ screens including real-time chat, polls, surveys, and streaming interfaces with consistent design patterns and type-safe props
- Architected scalable real-time chat application using Firebase and TypeScript, designing component architecture supporting 10,000+ user capacity (validated through load testing) with features including read receipts, media sharing, and bi-directional data synchronization
- Developed 3D metaverse event platform using Babylon.js and TypeScript, implementing immersive virtual office environment with spatial audio, avatar interactions, and real-time presence, tested with 12+ users for usability and performance
- Translated Figma designs into pixel-perfect production code, collaborating with designer on UI/UX decisions, implementing responsive components across multiple client projects, and optimizing performance through code splitting and lazy loading techniques
- Led stakeholder research synthesis for Fortune 500 corporate exhibition project, analyzing interview data to create narrative frameworks and interactive experience concepts, coordinating with 3D architecture team on Unity-based touch display implementations for Tata Steel and enterprise clients
- Served as technical lead for cross-functional team of 7, conducting code reviews, mentoring 2 developers on React and TypeScript best practices, and establishing Git workflows for collaborative development across metaverse platforms and web applications

Research Assistant, SETH Lab, Indiana University, Indianapolis, IN

Aug 2024 - Present

- Executed multi-modal user research with 41 participants testing VR emotion recognition system using Meta Quest Pro, synthesizing behavioral data, user self-reports, and empathy measures to establish accuracy baselines (73-88%) for adaptive VR applications
- Co-facilitated 3 participatory design sessions with 20+ child participants exploring VR game concepts, applying observational research and think-aloud protocols to understand user mental models and interaction preferences
- Created research protocols, moderator guides, and IRB documentation for multiple user studies; contributed to research operations including participant recruitment, screening, and ethical compliance procedures

UX Researcher, Autonomous Mobility as Social Service

Aug 2025 - Present

- Planned and executed mixed-methods user research study with 107 participants across 3 community sites, investigating user pain points in transportation access for underserved populations through interviews, participatory activities, and focus groups
- Developed AI-moderated interview methodology for vulnerable user populations, designing bilingual question protocols that achieved 27 participant responses within time-constrained service environments
- Synthesized user insights from 323 coded data points using thematic analysis, identifying transportation as critical barrier affecting user access to employment, healthcare, and education services
- Delivered research findings and 7 actionable design recommendations to stakeholders (Dec 2025), directly informing autonomous mobility service concepts for Spring 2026 development phase

SKILLS & METHODS

Front-End Development: React, TypeScript, JavaScript/ES6, HTML5, CSS3, component architecture, responsive design, performance optimization (code splitting, lazy loading), Figma-to-code implementation, design systems, Redux, Next.js, accessibility (WCAG)

3D & Immersive: Babylon.js, Three.js, Unity, WebGL, spatial computing, VR development (Meta Quest Pro), interactive installations

Back-End & Tools: Node.js, Firebase, Git, RESTful APIs, real-time data synchronization, scalable architecture design, collaborative development workflows

UX Research & Design: User interviews, usability testing, participatory design, heuristic evaluation, Figma, Figjam, prototyping, thematic analysis, mixed methods research, stakeholder collaboration

AI Tools: Vercel, Figma Make, Replit, Cursor, Napkin AI, Recraft AI, Claude for research, Genway AI, Maze

Research Operations: IRB protocols, participant recruitment, informed consent, bilingual research design, data privacy (GDPR)